COM345 comms plan

Lareb's Part

1. Background

Young people in Dubai aged 25 to 34 face rising cost-of-living pressures. Housing is the main driver, as Dubai's population is growing faster than new homes are built, with around 470 new residents arriving daily (The National, 2025). Rents are expected to rise by up to 6% in 2026 (Abbas, 2025), while average salaries were projected to see no increase in 2025 (ValuStrat, 2025). Transport costs have also grown, with peak-hour Salik tolls rising from AED 4 to AED 6 (Gulf Business, 2024). In addition, buy now, pay later data from Tabby and Tamara now appears on UAE credit reports, so everyday instalment purchases can affect future loans and rentals (Gulf News, 2026).

The main communication issue is that support already exists, such as the Dubai Land Department rental index and Etihad Credit Bureau credit reports, but many young people are unaware of it. Instead, they rely on social media, where unrealistic lifestyles and unverified advice are common, a risk the UAE has addressed by licensing finance influencers (Issa, 2025).

2. Problems and Opportunities

The problem is that young people in Dubai are facing rising living costs but lack clear and reliable guidance on how to manage them. Support services and educational resources already exist, but young people are unaware of them, and the active social media life spreads unrealistic expectations and misinformation about financial well-being.

This is an opportunity for YFWD to step in early, before it becomes a broader social problem. As a neutral organisation, YFWD can position itself as a trusted source of guidance by using platforms young people already use to promote financial literacy, responsible spending and saving, and awareness of available support.

Gleb's Part

Target Publics

Primary: Dubai residents aged 25-34, especially young professionals, graduates and renters.

Secondary: Universities, employers, banks, property providers, discount platforms and community organisations.

Message

“Dubai Life. Smarter Finances.”

Helping young people manage Dubai’s cost of living through informed financial decisions, practical planning and access to real cost-saving opportunities.

Strategy

Educate - Equip - Connect

> Educate: Social media content, workshops and practical advice on budgeting, rent, transport and saving.
>
> Equip: Provide budget-planning software, financial tools and cost-saving guides.
>
> Connect: Partner with banks, rental/property providers, Fazaa and other discount platforms, restaurants and food-delivery services to provide relevant financial benefits and discounts.
>
> Zywad bank card

Provide example calculation of how the same budget can be used better through the proposed savings

Amaliya’s Part

Channels and Tactics

The campaign will help young people in Dubai manage living expenses through the **Educate-Equip-Connect** strategy.

Educate: Publish two weekly Instagram and TikTok posts about budgeting, rent, transport and saving. Run six practical workshops through universities, employers and community organisations.

Equip: Create a campaign webpage with a free budget planner, savings calculator and practical guides. Promote it through QR codes and partner newsletters. Launch a "30-Day Budget Challenge" to help participants track spending and set savings goals.

Connect: Seek educational collaboration with Zywa, using its money-management app and prepaid-card model to explain spending control. Seek partnerships with banks, property providers, restaurants and discount platforms, including Fazaa, to share cost-saving opportunities. Clearly explain eligibility and offer conditions.

Savings example: Meal planning, suitable transport alternatives, fewer food-delivery orders and cancelling unused subscriptions could save AED 460 monthly. Within the same AED 6,000 budget, savings could increase from AED 500 to AED 960. This is an illustrative example; savings are not guaranteed or a card benefit.

Budget

Duration: 12 months. Total: AED 50,000.

Item	AED
Research and evaluation	5,000
Educational content	9,000
Social media advertising	10,000
Campaign webpage tools	6,000
Six workshops	9,000
Creator collaborations	4,000

Printing and QR posters	2,000
Partner coordination	2,000
Contingency	3,000
Total	**50,000**

Seek free venues, volunteer speakers and promotion through partner networks. Use existing YFWD staff and reusable materials to control costs. Confirm supplier prices before spending and review the budget monthly.

Akbar's part

3. Objectives

To support the *Educate, Equip, Connect* strategy, the campaign establishes three SMART (Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Results-oriented, Time-bound) objectives:

Objective 1 (Awareness / Educate):
To increase awareness of financial literacy and YFWD support resources among Dubai residents aged 25–34 by achieving 150,000 total impressions and a 4% average engagement rate on Instagram and TikTok campaign content within 6 months of launch.

Objective 2 (Behavioral Change / Equip):

To drive 5,000 downloads or active uses of the campaign webpage's free budget planner and guides, and to enroll 1,000 young professionals in the "30-Day Budget Challenge" within 12 months.

Objective 3 (Partnership & Engagement / Connect):
To engage at least 300 total participants across six interactive workshops and establish at least 4 active cost-saving partnerships (e.g., Zywa, Fazaa, rental/lifestyle platforms) by the end of the 12-month campaign period.

10. Evaluation and Modifications

Evaluation is conducted continuously across three distinct phases: **Beginning (Formative Research), Middle (Process Evaluation & Modification),** and **End (Summative Evaluation)**, to ensure the AED 50,000 budget delivers maximum impact and meets all campaign objectives.

Beginning: Baseline Evaluation (Formative)

Desktop Research & Social Listening: Monitor online discussions, hashtags, and social media trends surrounding Dubai living costs and financial management among young professionals (aged 25–34) before launch.
Pre-Campaign Survey: Conduct a short digital baseline survey (distributed through social media and university/employer channels) to measure existing awareness levels of YFWD resources, current spending habits, and top financial stress points.

Middle: Ongoing Monitoring & Modification (Process Evaluation)

Monthly Social Media Analytics: Track reach, engagement, click-through rates, and follower growth on Instagram and TikTok. If engagement falls below the target 4%, pivot content formats toward higher-performing Reels, creator collaborations, or interactive polls.
Webpage & Tool Tracking: Use Google Analytics to track visits to the campaign webpage, QR code scans from posters, downloads of the budget planner tool, and completion rates for the "30-Day Budget Challenge."
Mid-Campaign Review (Month 6): Assess workshop attendance and feedback forms. Reallocate unused portions of the AED 3,000 contingency budget toward higher-performing tactics (e.g., boosting social media advertising if web traffic needs a push).

End: Final Measurement (Summative Evaluation)

Post-Campaign Survey: Re-run the digital survey at Month 12 to measure shifts in financial awareness, self-reported saving behavior, and perception of YFWD as a trusted financial guidance source.

SMART Objective Audit:

Awareness: Total social media impressions vs. target (150,000).

Equip/Behavior: Total budget planner downloads (Target: 5,000) and 30-Day Challenge participants (Target: 1,000).

Connect: Total workshop attendance (Target: 300) and signed/active partner offers (Target: 4).

ROI & Future Planning: Summarize campaign reach per AED spent and compile a final evaluation report with recommendations for YFWD's long-term financial literacy initiatives.